Pick a niche and an offer that sells itself

A 10-minute worksheet. Do this before you look for a single lead: it decides who you call, what you say and what you charge.

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1. Score 3 to 5 trades in your town

Open Google Maps, search `[trade] in [your town]` for each trade you're considering, and score it 1 to 5 on each line.

	What it means	1	5
Job value	What one customer is worth to them (one job × how often they come back)	under $150	$1,000+
Gaps	How many listings have no Website button, or a broken or outdated site	almost none	1 in 5 or more
Busy	How many have 20+ reviews at 4.5★ or better (busy, trusted, missing the obvious)	a few	most of them
Reachable	Phone listed, a storefront you can walk into, owner-run	call centres, chains	owner answers
Your edge	You know the trade, know someone in it, or actually like it	none	strong

Trade	Job value	Gaps	Busy	Reachable	Your edge	Total /25
example: pressure washing, Tulsa	4	3	4	5	2	18

18 or more: start there. Pick ONE trade and ONE area for your first 30 days. "The website person for pressure washers in Tulsa" is easier to say, easier to trust and easier to price than "I do websites".

For scale, a real search (Google Maps, Oct 2026): "pressure washing in Tulsa OK" had 72 listings, 10 without a Website button. Busy trades in the suburbs and smaller towns next to a city usually have more gaps than downtown.

Good trades to score first: pressure washing, landscaping and lawn care, tree service, junk removal, painting, fencing, decks, handyman, cleaning, mobile detailing, pool service, pest control. Higher-ticket (bigger fees, harder sell): roofing, HVAC, remodeling, clinics, dental, law.

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2. Sell the outcome, not the website

Owners don't want "a website". They want the phone to ring. Fill in your one-line offer:

> I help **[trade]** in **[area]** get more **[calls / booked jobs]** from Google, with a site that shows every service and every town they cover, **[plus the monthly thing you do]**.

Example: *"I help pressure washers around Tulsa get more booked jobs from Google, with a site that shows every service and every town they cover, plus a page a month and a review system that keeps them on top."*

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3. Three packages (you set the prices)

Most owners pick the middle option, so make the middle one the one you want to sell.

	Starter	**Get Calls (recommended)**	**Grow**
What they get	Site live: home, services, contact, call button	Starter + a page for every service and town + Google Business Profile set up properly	Get Calls + monthly SEO pages, a review-request system, a one-page monthly report
Price shape	one-time	one-time + small monthly (hosting)	monthly

What the market charges, for reference: 2026 pricing guides put a freelance small-business site at roughly $1,500 to $8,000 one-time, and local SEO retainers commonly at $500 to $2,000 a month (Ahrefs' last survey average for local SEO: $1,557/month, 2023). You don't have to start there: lower prices while you build proof are fine, as long as you raise them once you have results.

Payment terms that protect you: 50% up front, 50% at launch; monthly billed in advance; 30 days' notice to cancel.

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4. The founding-client deal (your first 2 or 3)

No portfolio yet? Offer your first 2 or 3 clients a lower price in exchange for three things, in writing:

1. A testimonial you can quote (in their words, approved by them)

2. Permission to show their before and after as a case study
3. One introduction to another business owner they know

Ask for an honest Google review the same way you'd ask any client, but never as part of the deal: Google doesn't allow reviews in exchange for discounts or anything else.

Make it honest and time-limited: *"I'm taking 3 founding clients in [area] this month at [price]."* Only say it if it's true.

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5. Your one-pager (fill it in, then use it everywhere)

- **Who I help:** [trade] in [area]
- **What I see:** [their customers search Google and find a competitor / a broken page / nothing]
- **What I do:** [your one-line offer from section 2]
- **Packages:** Starter [$] · Get Calls [$ + $/mo] · Grow [$/mo]
- **Proof:** [a preview site you built for them, or your first case study]
- **Next step:** [call / text / walk-in], [your name], [phone], [business address]

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